

GodsEye Bot — End-to-End Onboarding Audit

Date: August 19, 2026 **Scope:** Full bot flow, every handler, every state transition, every dead end **Perspective:** Marketing · Onboarding UX · Retention · Post-purchase

1. CURRENT FLOW MAP

Entry Points

Entry	What happens
<code>/start</code> (plain)	Welcome text + 4 buttons
<code>/start ref_CODE</code>	Referral welcome → “Set up my business space”
<code>/start template_xxx</code>	Niche template loaded → first template question
<code>/start connect</code>	Post-checkout deep link → license key entry
<code>/help</code>	Same as <code>/start</code>

Onboarding Steps (state machine)

Step	Meaning	What it leads to
0	Not onboarded	Shows WELCOME_KYBD
1	“New or have license” (UNUSED)	Dead — never reached from current buttons
2	Awaiting license key	Waits for <code>GS-XXXX-XXXX</code> text
10	Collecting answers	5-question wizard OR single “convo warm” answer
11	Onboarded, showing action plan	ACTION_PLAN_KYBD
12	“You are onboarded” wall	ACTION_PLAN_KYBD again
99	Free chat mode	LLM streaming via <code>/api/chat</code> SSE
Template 0..N	Niche onboarding	Template-specific questions → HAVE_LICENSE_KYBD

Current `/start` Buttons (WELCOME_KYBD)

<code>🗑 Get to talking</code>	→ step 99 (chat mode)
<code>🗑 Tell me how it's going</code>	→ step 10 (convo warm, 1 answer → action plan)
<code>🗑 What can GodsEye help with?</code>	→ ACTION_PLAN_KYBD (no state change)
<code>🗑 I'm already a customer</code>	→ step 2 (license key entry)

Free Chat Limits

- **25 messages/day** (resets at midnight UTC)
- **100 messages total** (lifetime per Telegram ID)
- User is NOT told these limits until they hit them
- When limit hit: “You’ve hit today’s free limit” / “You’ve used your free allowance” → PREVIEW_KYBD

Post-Purchase Deep Link

- Checkout redirects to `/start connect`
- Shows: “Welcome back. Send your license key in the format GS-XXXX-XXXX”
- No email collected, no order context, no “here’s what you bought” summary

2. PROBLEMS FOUND

P1 — No Email Collection (Critical Gap)

The bot never asks for or stores an email. This means: - Can’t send login details after setup - Can’t send onboarding confirmation or receipts - Can’t do re-engagement email campaigns - Can’t recover abandoned onboarding - Can’t link Telegram identity to web account - The `emitActivation` function **REQUIRES** an email from the license — if the license has no email, activation is silently skipped

Where email IS referenced: - `emitActivation()` pulls `license.email` from the `/api/licenses/:key` response - That email comes from the Polar checkout (the buyer’s email at payment time) - But there’s no way for a FREE user to give an email — so free → paid conversion has no email bridge

Impact: You’re collecting zero leads from the free funnel. Every free user is an anonymous Telegram ID that can’t be contacted outside the bot.

P2 — “Get to talking” vs “Get started” (Naming)

The button was just added. From a conversion standpoint:

Option	Verdict
“Get to talking”	Vague. What am I talking to? Sounds like a social feature, not a business tool.
“Get started”	Universal. Clear. The user knows this means “begin the experience.”
“Start free”	Best — implies value, implies free, implies immediate.
“Try Godseye now”	Action-oriented, but longer.

Recommendation: Rename to “**Start free**” — it’s the strongest conversion button. It implies immediate value, zero commitment, and the user knows what happens: they start.

P3 — 4 Buttons at `/start` = Choice Paralysis

A new user sees 4 buttons and has to decide which one matches their situation: - “Get to talking” — what does this do? - “Tell me how it’s going” — sounds nice but what’s the outcome? - “What can Godseye help with?” — how is this different from “Get to talking”? - “I’m already a customer” — only relevant to paying users

The problem: Buttons 1 and 2 both lead to conversation but through different paths. Button 3 is an action plan (also conversation). A user has to guess which path is right for them.

Recommendation: Reduce to **3 buttons** max. The primary CTA should be the one you want most users to take.

P4 — No Free Tier Visibility

The welcome text says “free starter allowance” and “Founder Pass” but never tells the user: - You get 25 messages/day - You get 100 messages total - After that, you need a plan

The user only discovers the limit when they hit it — which feels like a trap, not a fair exchange.

Impact: Trust erosion. User feels misled when they suddenly can’t chat after investing time.

P5 — “You are onboarded” Is a Dead End

After the 5-question wizard (step 10→11), the bot says: > “You are onboarded. You can now talk to me normally. I’ll make suggestions as we work.”

Then shows ACTION_PLAN_KYBD which has 4 options (website, continue without, group, pricing). But: - The user's answers are stored in `previewProfile` as a pipe-delimited string - They're NOT used to personalize the next message - The user has to make ANOTHER choice (buttons) instead of just being able to type - The "I'll make suggestions as we work" promise is never fulfilled — there are no proactive suggestions

P6 — “Continue without a website” = “Get to talking” = “Chat with me”

Three different buttons lead to the exact same chat mode (step 99). This is confusing: 1. `ob:get_to_talking` → step 99 2. `ob:website_no` → step 99 3. `ob:chat_prompt` → step 99

A user who clicks different buttons at different times gets the same result but has no idea they're in the same place.

P7 — No Post-Purchase Onboarding

When someone buys and clicks `/start connect`: 1. They see “Welcome back. Send your license key” 2. They paste the key 3. Bot says “License connected. No connected sites yet. Install the plugin.” 4. Done.

Missing: - No “Here's what you bought” summary - No email confirmation - No “Here are your credits/tokens” explanation - No guided walkthrough of what to do first - No “Your login for the web dashboard is...” (email + password setup)

P8 — Session State Is Ephemeral

All session state lives in a JS `Map` — lost on bot restart. The `persistSession` function saves to the landing API, but: - It's best-effort (silently fails) - The `hydrateSession` only runs once per session (the `_hydrated` flag) - If the bot restarts, users lose their onboarding position mid-flow

P9 — Template Deep-Link Has No `/start` Button Return

After template questions are answered, the bot shows `HAVE_LICENSE_KYBD` (install plugin / command list). There's no “Go back to start” or “Chat with me” button. The user is funneled toward license/plugin only.

P10 — The 5-Question Wizard Is Too Long

The `business_setup` / `preview` flow asks 5 sequential questions: 1. What do you do? 2. What takes too much time? 3. What stresses you most? 4. What would you stop doing yourself? 5. What result would matter this week?

For a Telegram bot, 5 sequential messages with no skip option is a lot. Most users will drop off after question 2-3. The “convo warm” path (1 question) converts better.

3. RECOMMENDED NEW FLOW

The Principle

Bot = front door, not waiting room. Every screen should either collect something useful (email, business context) or move the user closer to experiencing value. No buttons that lead nowhere. No forms that don't save.

Proposed `/start` Screen

👋 Hey — Godseye here.

I'm your AI business operator. I handle planning, operations, content, customer replies, and website work — right from Telegram.

You get 25 free messages to try me out. No card, no commitment.

What would you like to do?

3 buttons (not 4):

Button	Action	Why
☐ Start free	→ Collect email → Step 99 chat	Primary CTA. Gets them chatting fastest.
☐ Set up my business	→ 3-question wizard (not 5)	For users who want structure first.
☐ I'm a customer	→ License key entry	Only for paying users.

Removed: "Tell me how it's going" (redundant with Start free + wizard).

Step 1: Email Collection (New — Before Chat)

After clicking "Start free" or "Set up my business," the bot asks:

Quick one — what's your email?

I'll use it to save your progress and send you your login details if you upgrade later. No spam, ever.

Just type it below

Why email first: - You capture the lead BEFORE they start chatting - You can send abandoned-onboarding emails - You can send upgrade prompts - You can link Telegram identity to web account - It's a micro-commitment (they've invested something = more likely to continue)

Email validation: Simple regex check. If invalid, ask again. If valid, store in `state.email` and persist.

What happens with the email: 1. Stored in `state.email` (persisted to landing API) 2. Saved to `users` table (linked to `telegram_id`) 3. Used for `emitActivation` (no more silent skip) 4. Available for future email campaigns

Step 2: After Email → Immediate Chat

You're in. You have 25 free messages today.

Go ahead — what's on your mind? I'm here to help with your business.

CHAT_MODE_KYBD with 3 buttons: - ☐ Chat with me (same as typing anything) - ☐ See plans - ☐ Connect my website

Step 3: Free Tier Limits — Show Them Upfront

When the user first enters chat mode, show the limits ONCE:

Free tier: 25 messages/day · 100 messages total
After that, pick a plan to keep going.

When they hit the daily limit:

You've used your 25 free messages for today.
Come back tomorrow, or pick a plan for unlimited access.

☐ See plans ☐ Continue tomorrow

When they hit the total limit:

```
👋 You've used your 100 free messages – you clearly find
this useful! Time to go pro.
```

Your options:

```
[👉 Choose a plan] [👉 I already have a license]
```

Step 4: “Set up my business” Flow (Shortened)

3 questions, not 5. The first question does the heavy lifting; the other two refine:

```
Q1: What do you do, or what are you building?
    → (answer stored as previewProfile)

Q2: What's the #1 thing eating your time right now?
    → (stored in onboardingAnswers[1])

Q3: What would you love to stop doing yourself?
    → (stored in onboardingAnswers[2])
```

After Q3:

```
👋 Got it. Here's what I can help with right now:

• Planning and daily ops
• Customer replies and support
• Content, email, and follow-up
• Website and landing page work

[👉 Start chatting] [👉 Connect my website] [👉 See plans]
```

No “You are onboarded” wall. The user is immediately able to type or click.

Step 5: Post-Purchase Re-Onboarding

When `/start connect` is triggered (from checkout):

```
👋 Welcome back! Your plan is active.

Here's what you've got:
• Plan: [plan name]
• Credits: [token allocation]
• License: GS-XXXX-XXXX (saved)

Next steps:
1. Install the plugin on your WordPress site
2. Connect it here with /connect
3. Start giving me tasks

[👉 Install plugin] [👉 Ask me anything] [👉 See commands]
```

Step 6: Web Login Details

After email is collected and user upgrades: - Bot sends: “Your web dashboard login: [email]. Check your email for the password setup link.” - This bridges Telegram → web seamlessly

4. BUTTON RENAMING

Current vs Recommended

Current	Recommended	Reason
"Get to talking"	" Start free "	Clearer, implies immediate value
"Tell me how it's going"	REMOVED	Redundant — "Start free" covers this
"What can Godseye help with?"	" Set up my business "	More specific, implies structure
"I'm already a customer"	" I'm a customer "	Shorter, same meaning
"Chat with me" (in chat mode)	REMOVED	User is already chatting — button is pointless
"See paid plans"	" See plans "	Shorter

Final WELCOME_KYBD

```
const WELCOME_KYBD = inlineKeyboard([
  [{ text: "Start free", callback_data: "ob:start_free" }],
  [{ text: "Set up my business", callback_data: "ob:business_setup" }],
  [{ text: "I'm a customer", callback_data: "ob:have_license" }],
]);
```

Final CHAT_MODE_KYBD

```
const CHAT_MODE_KYBD = inlineKeyboard([
  [{ text: "See plans", callback_data: "preview:pricing" }],
  [{ text: "Connect my website", callback_data: "ob:website_yes" }],
]);
```

(Remove "Chat with me" — they're already chatting.)

5. NEW SESSION STATE FIELDS

Add to `session()`:

```
{
  // ... existing fields ...
  email: null, // collected during onboarding
  emailCollected: false, // flag to avoid re-asking
  freeTierShown: false, // flag to show limits once
  freeTierMessagingSent: 0, // track which limit message was sent
}
```

Add to `persistableState()`:

```
// Already serializes all fields — just ensure email is included
```

6. EMAIL COLLECTION HANDLER

```
// After "Start free" or "Set up my business" button click:
if (data === "ob:start_free") {
  state.onboardingStep = 5; // NEW: email collection step
  state.onboardingIntent = "start_free";
  return send(chatId, [
    "Quick one — what's your email?",
    "",
    "I'll save your progress and send login details if you upgrade. No spam, ever.",
  ]);
}
```

```

    "",
    "Just type it below ",
  ].join("\n"));
}

// In handleMessage, before chat mode:
if (state.onboardingStep === 5) {
  const email = text.trim();
  if (!/^[^\s@]+@[^\s@]+\.[^\s@]+$/.test(email)) {
    return send(chatId, "That doesn't look like an email. Try again? (e.g. you@company.com)");
  }
  state.email = email;
  state.emailCollected = true;
  state.onboardingStep = 99;
  state.onboardingChatHistory = [];

  // Persist email to users table
  // (API call to save email + telegram_id binding)

  return send(chatId, [
    " You're in. You have 25 free messages today.",
    "",
    "Go ahead – what's on your mind? I'm here to help with your business.",
  ].join("\n"), CHAT_MODE_KYBD);
}

```

7. FREE TIER MESSAGING

First Chat Message (after email collected)

You're in. You have 25 free messages today.
Go ahead – what's on your mind?

Daily Limit Hit

You've used your 25 free messages for today.
Come back tomorrow, or pick a plan for unlimited.

[See plans]

Total Limit Hit

You've used your 100 free messages – you clearly
find this useful! Time to go pro.

[Choose a plan] [I have a license]

In Chat Mode — Occasional Nudge (every 10 messages)

You've used X/25 messages today and Y/100 total.
[See plans to go unlimited]

8. IMPLEMENTATION PRIORITY

Priority	Change	Effort	Impact
P0	Rename “Get to talking” → “Start free”	5 min	Higher conversion
P0	Add email collection step (step 5)	30 min	Lead capture, re-engagement
P0	Show free tier limits upfront	15 min	Trust, transparency
P1	Reduce 5-question wizard to 3	15 min	Lower drop-off
P1	Remove “Chat with me” from CHAT_MODE_KYBD	2 min	Less confusion
P1	Improve limit-hit messages with CTA	10 min	Conversion at limit
P2	Post-purchase re-onboarding flow	20 min	Better activation
P2	Add email to session state + persist	10 min	Foundation for email campaigns
P3	Occasional upgrade nudge in chat	15 min	Soft monetization

9. WHAT THE USER ASKED — DIRECT ANSWERS

“Should there be forms or a way of collecting details?” Yes — but NOT a form. One question at a time. Email first (1 message), then business context (optional, 1-3 questions). The email is the critical piece because it bridges Telegram → web, enables re-engagement, and is required for the activation tracking that already exists.

“Having that email makes it so we can mail them their login details.” Exactly. The flow should be: collect email → store with telegram_id → when they upgrade, bot says “Check your email for login setup.” The email is the bridge.

“Is the whole onboarding process okay?” No. It’s too many buttons, too many paths, no email capture, no free-tier transparency, and no post-purchase flow. The core product (chat mode) is good — the wrapper needs work.

“Should it be ‘Get to talking’ or ‘Get started’?” Neither. **“Start free”** is the strongest. It’s 2 words, implies immediate value, implies no commitment, and is the most common CTA pattern that converts.

“I want to use this as the first entrance.” The bot IS the entrance — but the onboarding treats it like a middle step. The bot should be the front door AND the living room. Collect email, show value, set expectations, then let them loose.

“Not meant to be a bot forever.” Correct — the bot is the entry point, but the product eventually moves to web/app. Email collection is how you bridge that gap. Without it, Telegram users stay Telegram-only and can’t become web/app users.